Jes H. Golden, Ph.D.

Curriculum Vitae

Affiliations

INDIANA UNIVERSITY, BLOOMINGTON

2025-2027 Visiting Scholar, Center for Possible Minds
2025-2027 Affiliated Research Fellow, Center on Religion and the Human
2025-2026 Postdoctoral Fellowship, Center for Possible Minds
Visiting Faculty, Borns Jewish Studies Program

HARVARD MEDICAL SCHOOL (MASS GENERAL HOSPITAL)

2025-2027 Postdoctoral Affiliate, Meditation Research Program, Harvard Medical School

Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY

2025 Ph.D., Philosophy, 2025, *Gut Feelings and Embodied Epistemology*
Advisors: John Campbell, Alva Noë, Frédérique de Vignemont (external)
2025 Exchange Scholar at Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Spring 2025)
Advisor: Sally Haslanger
2023 Chateaubriand Fellow at CNRS/ENS Institut Jean Nicod, Fall 2023
Advisor: Frédérique de Vignemont
2022-23 Exchange Scholar at Harvard University
Advisor: Samantha Matherne
2021 Advanced to Candidacy (Committee: Niko Kolodny, Alva Noë, Jay Wallace, Judith Butler)

SUNY GENESEO

2017 B.A. Philosophy, *summa cum laude*
Minor in Women's & Gender Studies
2015 University of Oxford, New College (study abroad)

Awards and Honors

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2024-5 Foundation for Philosophical Orientation Doctoral Fellowship, $30,000
2024 UC Berkeley Summer Dissertation Writing Grant, $6,000
2023 Chateaubriand Fellowship, French Embassy of the United States (HSS), €6,000
2023 Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute Fellow
2023 UC Berkeley Foreign Language & Area Studies Fellowship for French Study
2023 UC Berkeley Teaching Effectiveness Award (awarded to 0.5% of Berkeley GSIs)
2023 UC Berkeley Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award (<10% of GSIs)
2017 SUNY-wide Chancellor's Award (awarded to six graduating seniors)
2016 Phi Beta Kappa (early inductee)
2015 Leadership Alliance Mellon Initiative (Undergraduate Research Fellowship)

MISCELLANEOUS AFFILIATIONS AND TRAININGS

2025-28 Marbeh: Senior Jewish Mindfulness Teacher Fellowship, Institute for Jewish Spirituality
2023-25 Gates of Awareness: Jewish Meditation Teacher Training Program, Or HaLev
2023 Myisha Cherry's Emotion & Society Lab, Graduate Fellow
2020-21 USC Conceptual Foundations of Conflict, Affiliated Graduate Fellow

Published and Forthcoming Papers

Leckie, L., McClay, M., Bershad, A. K., **Golden, J.H.,** Rappe, S., & Foster, J. G.**.** The content and structure of dreams are coupled to affect (preprint). **Forthcoming** in *Scientific Reports*

Unpublished Papers Under Review and in Preparation

Golden, J.H., Sparby, T., and Sacchet, M.D. "Bodily Awareness in Advanced Meditation: A Three-Level Model of Interoceptive, Schematic, and Pacificatory Changes" (preprint). (**R&R** at *Mindfulness*)

Golden, J.H. "Bracketing the Self: Bodily Awareness and the Limits of Self-Frameworks in Advanced Meditation Research" [working title] Invited chapter for *The Oxford Handbook of the Science of Advanced Meditation*, ed. M. Sacchet. Oxford University Press. **(invited and in preparation)**

Golden, J.H. & Sacchet, M.D. "Devekut and the Relational Structure of Advanced Meditation" **(in preparation, available upon request)**

Golden, J.H. "Are Gut Feelings Mere Emotion?" **(under review)**

Golden, J.H. "Seamless Practice in Jewish Contemplative Life" **(in preparation)**

Presentations

Conference Presentations

2027 "Are Gut Feelings Mere Emotion?" **(accepted for presentation)**. *American Philosophical Association Central Division*, Denver, CO

2026 "Cleaving to the Divine: Devekut, Jewish Mysticism, and the Science of Advanced Meditation" (with M.D. Sacchet; **accepted for presentation)**. *Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Religion*, Contemplative Studies Unit, Denver, CO

2024 "How Gut Feelings Reorient Awareness" (invited) *Meeting for the 5th Anniversary of the Foundation for Philosophical Orientation,* Nashville, TN

2023 "Gut Feelings, Oppression, and Justice" *Lisbon Feminist Philosophy of Mind Workshop*, ArgLab, IFILNOVA, Lisbon, Portugal

2022 "The Horizons of Cultural Change: Lessons from Phenomenology *American Philosophical Association Eastern Division*, Baltimore, MD

Workshops

2026 "Selfhood in Emptiness and Relationality" (invited) *Center for Religion & the Human*, Indiana University, Bloomington

2024 "The Role of Unexpected Valence in Gut Feelings" (invited) *PRISM (Perception, Representation, Imagination, Space, Memory) Seminar*, Institut Jean Nicod, Paris, France

2023 "When Intuition Is Felt, Not Thought: Towards a Framework for Gut Feelings" *Myisha Cherry's Emotions & Society Lab*

2022 "Recognizing parts of ourselves" *Alva Noë's Friday Group*, Berkeley, CA

2018 "Gender, concepts and intuition" *Richard Wollheim Society*, UC Berkeley

COMMENTS

2023	Invited Commentator, "Felt Senses of Self" by E. Anderson *Boston Phenomenology Circle*, Boston, MA
2023	Commentator, "Toward a 'Mental View' of Sexual Difference" by J. McWeeny *APA Eastern Division*, Montréal, Canada
2022	Commentator, "Wisdom and KK Failure" by O. Nath *Berkeley-London Conference*, London, UK

Teaching Experience

AS GRADUATE STUDENT INSTRUCTOR

2022	Plato	Vanessa de Harven
2022	Phil. of Race, Ethnicity, Citizenship	Timothy Crockett
2021	Philosophy of Mind	Alva Noë
2021	Moral Psychology	Kwong-loi Shun
2020	Ethical Theories	Timothy Crockett
2020	Theory of Knowledge	Jason Winning
2020	Modern Philosophy	Timothy Crockett
2019	The Nature of Mind	Geoffrey Lee

Service & Other Experience

DEPARTMENTAL & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2023	Corrupt the Youth High School Outreach Volunteer
2022	Instructor for Directed Reading Program, Feminist Philosophy
2021	Mentor Coordinator at Pre-College Summer Institute in Justice and Ethics SUNY Geneseo
2020	Graduate Student Researcher for Syllabus Diversification Project
2018-22	PhilGeM (Philosophy Gender Minorities) Organizer, UC Berkeley

Graduate Coursework

2025	Mind-Wandering (audited at Harvard)	Susanna Siegel
2023	Intermediate French (150 Hours)	Institute Linguistique Adenet
	Self-Knowledge and Reflection (audited at Harvard)	Richard Moran
	Inquiry (audited at Harvard)	Susanna Siegel & Selim Berker
2021	The Human Experience Within Art, Technology, and Data	E. Wymore, G. Niemeyer, C. Emanuele Cella
2020	Feminist Epistemology	Andreja Novakovic
	Crisis & Entanglement in Art and Science	Alva Noë
	Equality & Rule	Niko Kolodny
	Aristotle	John MacFarlane
2019	Philosophy of Perception	Alva Noë
	Hume	Michael Martin
	Teaching Seminar	Alva Noë
2017	Art, Nature & Experience	Alva Noë
	Wittgenstein's Rule-Following	Hannah Ginsborg
	First-Year Graduate Seminar	Kristin Primus & Seth Yalcin

Languages

French

Intermediate reading proficiency
Conversational speaking ability

References

Alva Noë
Professor of Philosophy
University of California, Berkeley
noe@berkeley.edu

John Campbell
Willis S. and Marion Slusser Professor of Philosophy
University of California, Berkeley
jjcampbell@berkeley.edu

Jacob Foster
Professor of Informatics and Cognitive Science
Indiana University, Bloomington
jacobf@iu.edu

Frédérique de Vignemont
Institut Jean Nicod / École Normale Supérieure
frederique.de.vignemont@ens.fr

Matthew D. Sacchet
Associate Professor of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School
Director, Meditation Research Program, Massachusetts General Hospital
msacchet@mgh.harvard.edu

Tim Crockett (teaching reference)
Lecturer
University of California, Berkeley
crickett@berkeley.edu

Dissertation

Title: *Gut Feelings and Embodied Epistemology*

While philosophers have largely studied philosophical intuitions, intuitions with a *bodily* mode of presentation—or gut feelings—are among the most common types of intuitions we have in our social and moral lives. They also raise a distinctly different set of questions than philosophical intuitions. I argue that the mode of presentation for intuition makes a difference: when we are presented with intuitions in the bodily mode, they have as their content valence which is common to both emotion and, as I argue, to gut feeling. While I argue that gut feelings have an epistemic signature that distinguishes them conceptually from emotion, I also spell out the ways that gut feelings have distinct epistemic and ethical concerns by virtue of being easily entangled with emotions and other bodily feelings. Epistemically, I argue that we can glean some degree of evidence of adaptive value from gut feelings where we have previously demonstrated reliability. More conservatively, gut feelings are a gateway to self-knowledge and to our embodied epistemology: our pre-reflective habits, dispositions, tendencies, and ways of being in the world. There is an imperative to use our gut feelings at minimum to cultivate a balance of spectatorial and introspective self-knowledge through which we can make better choices aligned with our values, aims, and ethics. Through this process there is—at best—the possibility of getting better at having gut feelings.